MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級プラス
リーディングトレーニング

第14回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級プラス形式のリーディング第14回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To ( ) food poisoning in August, pack an ice pack beside rice balls in your lunch bag.

1 wind up **2** wear out **3** ward off **4** wipe away

(2) On ( ) of the graduating third-year students, Haruna presented a bouquet to the school nurse.

1 behalf **2** account **3** average **4** condition

(3) Because handmade cedar buckets dry out and leak if stored in heated rooms, coopers advise keeping them slightly ( ).

1 dense **2** deaf **3** dull **4** damp

(4) Under no circumstances ( ) untrained visitors enter the high-voltage transformer yard.

1 are **2** should **3** have **4** were

(5) After the ferry company modernized its hull engines, fuel consumption dropped by a ( ) of four.

1 fragment **2** fraction **3** factor **4** feature

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Even experienced potters occasionally throw away a batch when kiln temperatures get out of (　　).

1 arm　**2** head　**3** foot　**4** hand

(7) Students applying for the overseas exchange must submit two letters of recommendation in (　　) to their grade transcript.

1 addition　**2** advance　**3** accord　**4** appeal

(8) The old stone bridge stood intact through the flood, (　　) been reinforced with steel rods two years earlier.

1 have　**2** having　**3** had　**4** being

(9) When negotiations hit a wall, taking a fifteen-minute coffee break often helps both sides cool (　　).

1 down　**2** away　**3** over　**4** out

(10) This botanical guide groups wild mushrooms by gill color so beginners can tell edible species (　　) poisonous look-alikes.

1 into　**2** with　**3** from　**4** over

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

---

(11) Only a tiny fraction of meteorites fall near towns; the vast (　　) plunge unnoticed into the oceans.

1 monopoly　**2** margin　**3** maturity　**4** majority

(12) Whether we hold the flea market outdoors or in the gym (　　) on Saturday morning's radar forecast.

1 hinders　**2** hinges　**3** hovers　**4** hurdles

(13) Despite its (　　) exterior, the renovated warehouse hides a bright timber-lined chamber music hall inside.

1 polite　**2** plump　**3** plain　**4** prompt

(14) Please back up your thesis draft on two separate drives lest a sudden disk failure (　　) months of work.

1 wipes out　**2** wipe out　**3** wiped out　**4** wiping out

(15) When buying olive oil, choose dark green glass bottles because clear glass lets light (　　) its flavor.

1 degrade　**2** dedicate　**3** delegate　**4** delight

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

---

(16) Not a single train on the mountain line was canceled last winter, a record that speaks (　　) for the snowplow crew.

1 visions　**2** voices　**3** versions　**4** volumes

(17) Before dismantling the antique clock, the apprentice photographed every gear from three angles for future (　　).

1 reluctance　**2** residence　**3** reference　**4** reverence

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Library Archives Freeze Wet Books After a Pipe Leak

Discovering a burst water pipe above a library's rare-book stack is every archivist's nightmare. Within forty-eight hours at room temperature, damp paper swells, leather bindings warp, ink bleeds across pages, and black mold spores erupt across irreplaceable local histories. Trying to fan-dry two thousand soaked volumes one by one with hair dryers or paper towels is physically impossible before mold wins the race.

Counterintuitively, conservation scientists respond to water emergencies not with heat, but with industrial blast freezers. Workers slip soaked books into wax-paper sleeves, pack them spine-down in crates, and rush them into cold-storage warehouses kept below minus twenty degrees Celsius. Freezing halts mold growth and ink spreading in their tracks, buying conservators months to plan careful treatment. (18), turning liquid water into solid ice sets up a remarkable drying shortcut.

Batches of frozen books move into a vacuum freeze-drying chamber modeled on equipment used for instant coffee and astronaut food. Inside a near-vacuum, ice crystals locked between paper fibers sublimate—turning directly from solid ice into water vapor without ever melting back into liquid water. (19), coated art pages that would glue themselves permanently shut if air-dried come out separate, flat, and readable.

Rapid freezing and sublimation show how applying phase-change physics can (20).

(18)

1 Better still
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 In vain

(19)

1 Reluctantly
2 Conversely
3 Instead of ice
4 Thanks to this

(20)

1 turn paper novels into instant coffee for astronauts
2 rescue cultural heritage that ordinary drying would destroy
3 keep library reading rooms below minus twenty degrees
4 wash muddy shoes faster than hot water

How "Dark Sky" Towns Cut Glare and Revive Overnight Tourism

Stand in the center of most modern cities on a cloudless night, and you are lucky to count two dozen stars overhead; the Milky Way, visible to every human generation before 1900, is now hidden from roughly eighty percent of people in North America, Europe, and Japan by artificial skyglow. Much of that glow is pure waste—unshielded parking-lot lamps and billboards firing light sideways into bedrooms and straight up into empty clouds.

Over the past fifteen years, dozens of rural municipalities and island communities—from Kozushima and Bisei in Japan to towns in Scotland and Utah—have pursued official certification as "International Dark Sky Places." Achieving that status does not mean plunging streets into unsafe darkness. Instead, towns audit every municipal fixture, add full top shields so light falls solely on roads below, lower color temperatures from harsh blue-white to warm amber, and dim empty sports fields after ten p.m. (21), municipal street-lighting electricity bills routinely fall by thirty to fifty percent.

Unexpected economic rewards have followed. City families hungry to see Saturn's rings or summer meteor showers book weekend inn stays rather than rushing out on day trips, filling restaurants and local ferries during quieter off-season months. (22), nocturnal seabirds and sea-turtle hatchlings along island beaches stop getting disoriented by coastal hotel glare.

Thoughtful lighting reform demonstrates that curbing pollution can simultaneously (23).

(21)

1 Otherwise
2 On the contrary
3 In the process
4 In vain

(22)

1 Previously
2 Conversely
3 Instead of stars
4 Just as importantly

(23)

1 save public money, boost local inns, and protect night wildlife
2 keep sports stadiums lit at noon brightness until dawn
3 hide the Milky Way from island residents forever
4 double municipal electricity bills every winter

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Updated Bike-Rack Sticker System for Student Commuters

From: Student Guidance Office, Aoba High School
To: Students Commuting by Bicycle
Subject: Reflective permit stickers and helmet-hook check starting May 11

Dear bicycle commuters,
Because thirty more first-year students registered bicycles this spring than last year, we have reorganized our covered bike sheds by grade color starting Monday, May 11: YELLOW stickers for first-years (East Shed), GREEN for second-years (Center Shed), and SILVER for third-years (West Shed).

Please pick up your new reflective sticker from your homeroom teacher this week and press it onto the rear mudguard—NOT onto the front basket, where rain covers hide it during morning checks. Wipe dust off the metal first so the sticker does not peel off in June rain.

Students who park electric-assist bicycles must also bring a spare battery-key number to the office in case a key is lost on campus.

Student Guidance Office

Updated Bike-Rack Sticker System for Student Commuters — Questions

(24) Why has Aoba High School reorganized its bicycle sheds by grade color?

1 The West Shed was torn down to build a swimming pool.

2 Thirty more first-year students registered bicycles this spring than last year.

3 Third-year students stopped riding bicycles in May.

4 Only electric-assist bicycles are allowed now.

(25) Where must students attach their new reflective permit sticker?

1 On the rear mudguard after wiping dust off the surface.

2 On the front basket under a rain cover.

3 Inside their classroom locker.

4 Underneath the bicycle saddle.

(26) What additional step is required for students riding electric-assist bicycles?

1 Removing the battery during math class.

2 Parking outside the school gate on rainy days.

3 Registering their spare battery-key number with the guidance office.

4 Applying two yellow stickers to the handlebars.

Why Traditional Lime Plaster Is Returning to Modern Homes

Walk into a centuries-old Japanese storehouse (kura), a Mediterranean courtyard villa, or a timber cottage in Cotswold England, and the matte white walls feel noticeably calmer and fresher on a muggy afternoon than rooms finished with modern vinyl wallpaper. Builders achieved that indoor comfort long before electric dehumidifiers using a mineral coating cooked from limestone, water, and plant fibers: slaked-lime plaster, known in Japan as shikkui.

After World War II, lime plaster fell out of favor in mass housing because applying thin coats evenly with a steel trowel required years of apprenticeship and weeks of slow curing. Synthetic vinyl wallcoverings and acrylic paints could be rolled or glued onto drywall in a single afternoon at a fraction of the labor cost. Yet sealing homes ever tighter with plastic films created an unintended indoor complaint: trapped cooking steam, bath moisture, and volatile glues triggered condensation and mold behind wallpaper.

Materials scientists studying historic plasters found that cured lime acts like a microscopic mineral lung. Packed with countless nanometer-scale pores, a shikkui wall absorbs excess water vapor from indoor air during humid rainy-season weeks and releases it gently back into the room when winter heating turns air dry.

Its natural chemistry fights microbes too. Freshly cured calcium hydroxide maintains high alkalinity that prevents black mold spores and dust mites from colonizing bathroom corridors or closets without synthetic fungicides—one reason historic silk scrolls and grain survived safely inside earthen storehouses.

To make lime accessible for ordinary budgets today, manufacturers have developed pre-mixed roller pastes and lime-coated wallboards, blending ancestral building wisdom with contemporary construction speed.

Why Traditional Lime Plaster Is Returning to Modern Homes — Questions

(27) Why did builders largely switch from lime plaster to vinyl wallpaper after World War II?

1 Governments banned white walls inside houses.

2 Limestone mines ran out across Europe and Japan in 1950.

3 Vinyl wallpaper absorbed ten times more moisture than lime.

4 Lime plaster needed skilled trowel work and slow drying, whereas vinyl went up quickly and cheaply.

(28) What indoor problem arose when tightly sealed modern houses were lined with plastic wallcoverings?

1 Rooms became too cold to heat in July.

2 Trapped moisture and glues led to condensation and mold growth behind wallpaper.

3 Wooden floors turned into solid limestone.

4 Windows shattered whenever someone cooked soup.

(29) How does cured shikkui plaster regulate room humidity across seasons?

1 It drips liquid water onto the floor every rainy day.

2 It uses hidden electric fans embedded inside limestone.

3 Its microscopic pores absorb excess moisture in humid months and release it when winter air dries out.

4 It seals rooms completely airtight like a plastic bag.

(30) Why does lime plaster naturally resist black mold without synthetic chemicals?

1 It reaches boiling temperature every midnight.

2 Its high alkalinity prevents mold spores and mites from growing on the surface.

3 It smells strongly of lemon perfume.

4 Insects eat all the mold every morning.

(31) How have manufacturers made lime finishes easier to adopt in contemporary homes?

1 By creating pre-mixed roller pastes and ready-to-install lime-coated wallboards.

2 By requiring every homeowner to train as an apprentice for ten years.

3 By replacing limestone with melted plastic bottles.

4 By limiting lime strictly to nineteenth-century museums.